Can Sealer



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Can sealer

What it is used for

A can sealer closes compatible metal or other approved cans by forming a secure seam or closure. Correct can and lid matching, machine adjustment, hygienic handling, and seam inspection help prevent leakage, contamination, and product spoilage.

Main parts

- Machine frame supports the seaming mechanism.
- Can platform or chuck holds and positions the can.
- Seaming rollers form the closure seam.
- Chuck or seaming head supports the lid during sealing.
- Drive motor powers the sealing mechanism.
- Can height adjustment accommodates approved container sizes.
- Control switch or pedal starts and stops the machine.
- Safety guard protects the operator from moving components.
- Seam inspection tools check closure quality where provided.

Before you start

1. Only trained personnel should operate the can sealer.
2. Read the manual and confirm that the can body, lid, and seam tooling are compatible.
3. Inspect the frame, rollers, chuck, guards, controls, cables, and adjustment mechanisms for damage.
4. Clean and sanitise food-contact surfaces according to the facility hygiene procedure.
5. Check cans and lids for dents, corrosion, deformation, contamination, or other defects.
6. Verify roller settings, chuck size, can height, and operating speed against approved packaging specifications.
7. Ensure the machine is stable and that required guards and emergency stops function correctly.

How to use

1. Prepare the can and lid according to the approved filling and packaging procedure.
2. Check that the filled can has the specified headspace and that its rim is clean and undamaged.
3. Install the correct chuck and seaming tooling for the can and lid format with power isolated.
4. Set the can height, roller positions, and other adjustments according to the machine manual and packaging specification.
5. Place the lid squarely on the can without damaging the rim or contaminating the sealing surfaces.

6. Position the can securely on the platform or chuck and confirm correct alignment.
7. Close the guard and activate the seaming cycle using the designated control.
8. Keep hands clear while the rollers form the seam and allow the cycle to finish completely.
9. Remove the can only after the mechanism has returned to its safe position.
10. Inspect the seam for folds, sharp edges, gaps, looseness, or other visible defects.
11. Perform specified seam measurements or integrity tests at the required sampling frequency and record results.
12. Stop the machine and isolate power before cleaning, adjustment, jam clearing, or maintenance.

⚠ Safety

- Never place fingers near rotating rollers, the chuck, or the moving can platform.
- Do not operate with missing guards, faulty controls, or damaged seaming tooling.
- Never adjust rollers or clear a jam while the machine is running.
- Use only can bodies, lids, and tooling approved for the machine and product.
- Handle sharp or damaged can edges carefully and dispose of defective containers safely.
- Follow validated food-processing and closure-integrity requirements; a visually acceptable seam alone may not prove hermetic integrity.

Care & storage

- Clean and sanitise product-contact areas after production according to the approved procedure.
- Remove can fragments and residue only after isolating the machine.
- Inspect rollers, chuck, bearings, guards, and adjustment mechanisms for wear.
- Lubricate designated components only with the specified lubricant and method.
- Arrange authorised maintenance if seam quality changes or the machine develops abnormal noise or vibration.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using mismatched can bodies, lids, chuck, or seaming rollers.
- Incorrect roller adjustment causing a loose or defective seam.
- Removing a can before the seaming cycle finishes.
- Relying only on visual inspection without required seam testing.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.